

The dual avoidance

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Dual is a weakness in an orthodox direct mate problem where more than one mate follow a single black defence. Later on in modern compositions 'dual separation' and dual avoidance have become an integral part of many themes and considered embellishments. There are many ways of preventing the duals like 'Herpai' and 'Java'. In the diagram below the arrival of a dummy unit on d3 (after the key 1.d4!) would permit a dual mate 2.Nxc3 and 2.Nxe3 as each BR ceased to guard its companion..

L.I.Loshinski
Die Schwalbe 1930



Mate in two moves

It is the departure effects of black's en passant capture defences that stop duals. **Key 1.d4!** (threat 2.Qc5) 1...dxc4 e.p 2.Nxe3 (2.Nxc3?) 1...exd4 e.p 2.Nxc3 (2.Nxe3?) 1...fNe6 2.Rxd7; 1...gNe6 2.Rxf5 This kind of interference play is called 'Herpai' theme and is a form of dual defence. It may be noted that similar pair of interferences by the knights on e6 do not constitute dual avoidance at all. The moves are merely double errors of interference and unguards.

In the second problem features 'Java' theme -so called because Tuxen in the early 1930s investigated it while

he was living in Java. In fact according to John Rice, Mansfield composed the first example in 1919.

P.Keres

I prize, Schachvarlden 1934



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Rh4! (threat 2.Rb4)

1...Be4 2.Nd4 (Nc5?)

1...Ne7 2.Nc5 (Nd4?)

1...Re4 2.Qb1

Be4 closes WRs additional guard to b4 and so the unpinned WN must avoid closing WB guard to that square. Similarly Ne7 closes WB guard to b4 and WN avoids closing WR line

The interest in the problem for solving given below lies in the 'quintuple avoidance' of mates.

P.Overkamp(after Loshinski)
Probleemblad 1951



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Prevention of check':

Key 1.Bg5! (2.Bf4) 1...Bd2 2.Bxd3

3.Bg6

1...Bc3 2.Kc6 3.Bf7; 1...Bb4 2.Ke4

3.Bf7; 1...Ba5 2.b8Q; 1...d2 2.Ke5

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com